



EXECUTIVE GO TO MARKET GUIDE

Go to Market Strategy and Readiness Guide 2026

A decision framework for selecting markets, designing the commercial motion and scaling with evidence

Prepared for Canadian boards, founders, chief executives, product, marketing, sales, customer success, finance and operations leaders

Prepared by ROALLA Transformation and Technology Advisory

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Purpose

This guide helps leadership determine where to compete, which customers to prioritize and how to reach them with a credible offer and repeatable commercial motion. It connects market evidence, ideal customer selection, positioning, packaging, channels, sales capacity, customer experience, economics and launch governance.

EXECUTIVE DECISION DASHBOARD

Management View at a Glance

A go to market strategy should concentrate investment where customer need, differentiation, delivery capability and economics reinforce one another. Management should scale only after the organization can explain who buys, why they choose, how they progress, what it costs to acquire and serve them, and which evidence will trigger further investment.

Executive question	ROALLA view	Decision implication
Is the target market specific enough?	CONDITIONAL	Prioritize segments using need, access, economics, competition and strategic fit.
Is the ideal customer evidence based?	PREPARE	Validate buying triggers, roles, alternatives, barriers, adoption and retention potential.
Is the commercial motion repeatable?	CONDITIONAL	Test channels, journey, proof, handoffs, cycle, conversion and delivery capacity.
Are the economics scale ready?	DECIDE	Model acquisition, margin, implementation, support, retention, expansion and cash requirements.
What should management authorize?	PURSUE	A 90-day market validation and go to market blueprint.

Recommended Management Posture

Proceed through a small number of explicit decision gates. Preserve evidence as work occurs, separate discovery from implementation, and require each investment to demonstrate value, feasibility, control effectiveness and accountable ownership before scale.

EXECUTIVE DECISION MODEL

The Eight Go to Market Readiness Gates

Go to market readiness is more than a launch plan. It is the alignment of customer evidence, offer, route to market, delivery capacity and economics. Weak evidence at any gate changes the decision from scale to focused preparation or market learning.

Stage	Gate	Required conclusion	Decision evidence
01	Market	An attractive and reachable opportunity exists	Size, growth, urgency, access, competition and constraints
02	Customer	Priority buyers and users are understood	Ideal profile, jobs, triggers, process and decision roles
03	Problem	Need and willingness to change are evidenced	Research, alternatives, urgency and purchase barriers
04	Offer	Value, proof, packaging and price fit the segment	Outcome, differentiation, evidence and unit economics
05	Motion	Routes to demand, sale and adoption are coherent	Channels, journey, handoffs, cycle and conversion
06	Capability	Teams and partners can deliver the promise	Roles, capacity, enablement, service and operations
07	Economics	Growth can create durable contribution	Acquisition cost, margin, payback, retention and cash needs
08	Learning	Launch decisions use defined evidence	Measures, experiments, thresholds and investment gates

Decision Rule

A failed hard gate moves the initiative to Prepare or Monitor. A strong narrative, senior sponsor or attractive market cannot replace missing authority, evidence, delivery capacity or operating control.

SECTION 01

Readiness Framework

Translate ambition into a shared executive view of value, evidence, capability and risk.



MANAGEMENT ASSESSMENT MODEL

Readiness Dimensions

No.	Decision area	Management evidence	Status
01	Market attractiveness	Need, growth, competition, access, regulation and strategic fit	Confirmed / Developing / Gap
02	Customer evidence	Ideal profile, buyers, users, triggers, barriers and desired outcomes	Confirmed / Developing / Gap
03	Offer and positioning	Value proposition, differentiation, proof, packaging and price	Confirmed / Developing / Gap
04	Commercial motion	Demand, channels, sales process, partners, adoption and handoffs	Confirmed / Developing / Gap
05	Capability and capacity	Roles, skills, technology, delivery, service and leadership	Confirmed / Developing / Gap
06	Economics and learning	Acquisition, margin, retention, cash, measures and investment gates	Confirmed / Developing / Gap

Evidence Standard

Assessments should distinguish verified evidence from management confidence. Where evidence is incomplete, record the gap, owner, completion date and decision that depends on it.

STRATEGIC READINESS DEPENDENCIES

What Readiness Depends On

Dependency	Why it matters	Evidence management should expect
Market	An attractive and reachable opportunity exists	Size, growth, urgency, access, competition and constraints
Customer	Priority buyers and users are understood	Ideal profile, jobs, triggers, process and decision roles
Problem	Need and willingness to change are evidenced	Research, alternatives, urgency and purchase barriers
Offer	Value, proof, packaging and price fit the segment	Outcome, differentiation, evidence and unit economics
Motion	Routes to demand, sale and adoption are coherent	Channels, journey, handoffs, cycle and conversion
Capability	Teams and partners can deliver the promise	Roles, capacity, enablement, service and operations
Economics	Growth can create durable contribution	Acquisition cost, margin, payback, retention and cash needs
Learning	Launch decisions use defined evidence	Measures, experiments, thresholds and investment gates

ROALLA Interpretation

Dependencies should be evaluated as a connected system. A weakness in ownership, data, architecture, delivery or governance can change the economics and risk of an otherwise attractive initiative.

SECTION 02

Detailed Readiness Assessment

Convert executive intent into verifiable requirements, accountable evidence and clear remediation actions.



READINESS CHECKLIST

Market Customer and Offer Readiness

Completion standard Mark Ready only when the supporting evidence has been verified. Assign an evidence owner to every open item.

Gate	Readiness requirement	Ready	Gap	Evidence owner
A01	Priority markets are screened for need, growth, access, competition, regulation and strategic fit.	☐	☐	_____
A02	The target segment is narrow enough to support distinctive product, message and route decisions.	☐	☐	_____
A03	The ideal customer profile includes need, fit, buying likelihood, economics and retention potential.	☐	☐	_____
A04	Buyers, users, influencers, approvers and procurement roles are mapped with decision criteria.	☐	☐	_____
A05	Customer research validates the problem, current alternatives, urgency and cost of inaction.	☐	☐	_____
A06	The value proposition connects differentiated capability to measurable customer outcomes.	☐	☐	_____
A07	Performance claims, references and proof are accurate, authorized and appropriate to the context.	☐	☐	_____
A08	Packaging and pricing are understandable, attainable and aligned to value and cost to serve.	☐	☐	_____
A09	The offer includes implementation, adoption, support, renewal and expansion expectations.	☐	☐	_____
A10	Localization needs cover language, culture, accessibility, privacy, contracts and market rules.	☐	☐	_____

READINESS CHECKLIST CONTINUED

Commercial Motion and Scale Readiness

Completion standard Use Gap to create a dated remediation action and identify the management decision that cannot proceed.

Gate	Readiness requirement	Ready	Gap	Evidence owner
B01	Inbound, outbound, channel, product led and partner roles are chosen for segment economics.	☐	☐	_____
B02	The customer journey defines evidence, owners and handoffs from awareness through expansion.	☐	☐	_____
B03	Demand assumptions are supported by channel tests, conversion evidence and realistic reach.	☐	☐	_____
B04	Sales cycle, proof requirements, procurement and implementation dependencies are understood.	☐	☐	_____
B05	Marketing, sales, product and customer success capacity matches the launch ambition.	☐	☐	_____
B06	Partners have a clear role, economic model, enablement plan, accountability and conflict rules.	☐	☐	_____
B07	Commercial systems capture consent, source, progression, cost, conversion and customer outcome.	☐	☐	_____
B08	Acquisition cost, margin, payback, retention and cash needs are tested under scenarios.	☐	☐	_____
B09	Launch measures distinguish awareness, learning, pipeline, revenue, adoption and retention.	☐	☐	_____
B10	Investment gates define when to scale, adapt, pause or exit a market or motion.	☐	☐	_____

WEIGHTED EXECUTIVE ASSESSMENT

Readiness Scorecard

Dimension	Weight	Evidence standard	Score	Status
Market attractiveness	20%	Need, growth, competition, access, regulation and strategic fit	__/20	Strong / Developing / Gap
Customer evidence	20%	Ideal profile, buyers, users, triggers, barriers and desired outcomes	__/20	Strong / Developing / Gap
Offer and positioning	15%	Value proposition, differentiation, proof, packaging and price	__/15	Strong / Developing / Gap
Commercial motion	15%	Demand, channels, sales process, partners, adoption and handoffs	__/15	Strong / Developing / Gap
Capability and capacity	15%	Roles, skills, technology, delivery, service and leadership	__/15	Strong / Developing / Gap
Economics and learning	15%	Acquisition, margin, retention, cash, measures and investment gates	__/15	Strong / Developing / Gap
TOTAL	100%	Weighted executive assessment	__/100	Pursue / Prepare / Monitor

Decision Thresholds

Score	Posture	Management decision
75 to 100	PURSUE	Proceed to bounded execution subject to no hard-gate failure.
50 to 74	PREPARE	Complete a focused readiness plan before major commitment.
0 to 49	MONITOR	Resolve foundational gaps before investing further.

A single material hard-gate failure overrides the weighted score. ROALLA also applies judgment where administrative readiness is high but strategic value, adoption or commercial viability is weak.

SECTION 03

Execution and Advisory Roadmap

Move from market thesis to controlled commercial evidence before committing to broad launch or headcount expansion.



READINESS OPERATING PLAN

Recommended 90 Day Mobilization

Timing	Focus	Key activities	Management output
Days 1 to 15	Frame	Confirm growth thesis, candidate markets, decision criteria, constraints and evidence.	Approved market thesis
Days 16 to 35	Discover	Analyze markets, customers, competitors, alternatives, channels and current commercial results.	Prioritized evidence base
Days 36 to 55	Design	Define target segment, value proposition, offer, price, journey, motion and economics.	Go to market blueprint
Days 56 to 75	Validate	Run customer, channel, message, offer and delivery tests with explicit thresholds.	Validated launch recommendation
Days 76 to 90	Authorize	Approve launch scope, capacity, budget, measures, owners and stop scale gates.	Executive launch decision

Twelve to Twenty Four Month Path

- Quarter 1: validate priority segment, customer problem, differentiated offer and channel assumptions.
- Quarter 2: launch a controlled motion with complete customer, commercial and economic measurement.
- Quarters 3 and 4: scale only the repeatable channels, roles, partners and enablement patterns.
- Year 2: enter adjacent segments or markets only when core economics, retention and delivery remain strong.

ROALLA ADVISORY MODEL

How ROALLA Can Help

ROALLA acts as the technology and commercialization advisor coordinating market evidence, offer design, customer experience, commercial architecture, partners, operating readiness and executive investment decisions. The objective is a focused route to repeatable growth rather than a larger collection of disconnected campaigns.

ROALLA workstream	Executive value
Market opportunity assessment	Screen and prioritize markets using need, access, competition, risk, economics and strategic fit.
Customer and buying insight	Define ideal customers, buying roles, triggers, barriers, alternatives and decision evidence.
Positioning and offer design	Align value proposition, proof, packaging, pricing and implementation expectations.
Commercial motion design	Choose channels, customer journey, sales model, partner roles and lifecycle handoffs.
Capability and technology	Define roles, capacity, CRM, data, automation, enablement and delivery dependencies.
Economics and investment case	Model acquisition, margin, payback, retention, expansion, cash and scenarios.
Market validation	Structure experiments, customer evidence, launch measures and stop scale thresholds.
Launch and evolution assurance	Monitor evidence, risk, operating readiness and management decisions through scale.

Recommended Initial Mandate

- Four-week go to market strategy and readiness diagnostic.
- Priority market, ideal customer and buying evidence assessment.
- Target offer, commercial motion, capability and economic blueprint.
- Executive launch recommendation and 90-day validation plan with decision gates.

CONTROL FRAMEWORK

Key Risks and Controls

Risk	Exposure	ROALLA control
Market breadth	Resources are dispersed across too many segments.	Prioritize with explicit attractiveness, access and fit criteria.
Weak evidence	Customer assumptions are mistaken for demand.	Require research, behavioural proof and paid commitment where possible.
Generic position	The offer sounds similar to every alternative.	Connect differentiated capability to a priority measurable outcome.
Channel mismatch	The route to market cannot support the economics.	Test reach, conversion, cycle, cost and customer experience by channel.
Price confusion	Fees, terms or packaging undermine trust.	Use clear attainable pricing and review marketing and contractual claims.
Delivery gap	Sales growth exceeds implementation or service capacity.	Link commercial gates to delivery, support and adoption capacity.
Compliance gap	Outreach or data use creates legal and reputation risk.	Validate consent, privacy, marketing, accessibility and market obligations.
Scaling early	Investment expands before repeatability is established.	Use evidence thresholds and controlled market learning stages.

Professional Advice

Qualified legal, privacy, security, tax, accounting, employment and regulatory advisors should validate matters within their professional scope. ROALLA coordinates those inputs with technology strategy, architecture, commercialization, governance and transformation decisions.

OFFICIAL EVIDENCE BASE

Selected Official Sources

These sources support the management principles summarized in this guide. Standards, laws, guidance and organizational obligations continue to evolve and must be confirmed for the specific context before acting.

Trade Commissioner Service target market research. [Official source](#) — Official guidance for screening, assessing and selecting international target markets.

Trade Commissioner Service assessing export potential. [Official source](#) — Official readiness considerations for international market entry, resources, competitiveness and delivery.

Trade Commissioner Service CanExport SMEs. [Official source](#) — Current program status, eligibility direction and support for eligible Canadian SMEs entering new international markets.

CRTC Canada anti spam legislation. [Official source](#) — Official requirements and guidance for commercial electronic messages, consent, sender identification and unsubscribe mechanisms.

Competition Bureau Canada deceptive marketing practices. [Official source](#) — Official guidance on representations, performance claims, pricing and the general impression created by marketing.

Office of the Privacy Commissioner of Canada privacy for businesses. [Official source](#) — Current guidance for private sector privacy programs, customer information and marketing practices.

Advisory Disclaimer

This ROALLA guide is a strategic readiness and marketing document. It is not a certification, audit opinion, legal opinion, privacy opinion, security assurance, investment recommendation or guarantee of results. Management must validate current obligations, company facts and professional advice before making material decisions.